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Female terminal fitting with durable elastic contact piece

Abstract

Provided is a female terminal fitting capable of improving the durability of an elastic contact piece. A female terminal fitting (10) includes a tubular main body part (20) and an elastic contact piece (40) extending, inside the main body part (20), from a support point part (41) to a free end part (42) and contacting a partner-side male tab (120) inserted in the main body part (20). The free end part (42) side of the elastic contact piece (40) displaces in the plate thickness direction of the elastic contact piece (40). The main body part (20) has a first regulating part (31) and a second regulating part (32) that come in contact with the elastic contact piece (40) and regulate a displacement range of the free end part (42) side to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece (40).

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a national phase of PCT application No. PCT/JP2021/012157, filed on 24 Mar. 2021, which claims priority from Japanese patent application No. 2020-080458, filed on 30 Apr. 2020, all of which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to a female terminal fitting.

BACKGROUND

(3) A female terminal of Patent Document 1 includes a tubular main body part and an elastic contact plate supported inside the main body part and extending from one opening into which a male terminal is inserted toward the other opening. The elastic contact plate is provided with a pair of wings protruding in the width direction. The wings are positioned in holes provided in side plate parts of the main body part. There is a clearance between upper and lower edge parts of the holes and the wings. Movement in the up-down direction is regulated by the wings coming in contact with the upper and lower edges of the holes. The terminal fittings of Patent Documents 2 to 5 are also similarly configured such that movement of an elastic contact plate in the up-down direction is regulated by a regulating part of the main body part.

PRIOR ART DOCUMENT

Patent Document

(4) Patent Document 1: JP 2017-147095 Å Patent Document 2: JP 2017-033866 A Patent Document 3: JP 2006-294496 A Patent Document 4: JP 2006-216315 A Patent Document 5: JP 2005-166594 A

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Problems to be Solved

(5) With the female terminal of Patent Document 1, it is conceivable that, when an external force is applied to the elastic contact plate, a region of a support point part side (one opening side) of the elastic contact plate will be damaged due to increased stress on the support point part side. In particular, the female terminal of Patent Document 1 has a relatively large clearance between the upper and lower edges of the holes and the wings, and thus displacement of the wings increases, and the elastic contact plate is easily deformed.

(6) The present disclosure has been completed based on circumstances such as the above, and an object thereof is to provide a female terminal fitting capable of improving the durability of an elastic contact piece.

Means to Solve the Problem

(7) A female terminal fitting of the present disclosure includes: a tubular main body part; and an elastic contact piece extending, inside the main body part, from a support point part to a free end part and contacting a partner-side male tab inserted in the main body part, the free end part side of the elastic contact piece displacing in a plate thickness direction of the elastic contact piece, and the main body part having a regulating part that comes in contact with the elastic contact piece and regulates a displacement range of the free end part side to less than or equal to a plate thickness of the elastic contact piece.

Effect of the Invention

(8) According to the present disclosure, a female terminal fitting capable of improving the durability of an elastic contact piece can be provided.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a right side view of a female terminal fitting of a first embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a front view of the female terminal fitting.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a left side view of the female terminal fitting.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a plan view of the female terminal fitting.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a bottom view of the female terminal fitting.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view taken along A-A in FIG. 2.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view taken along B-B in FIG. 2.
- (8) FIG. 8 is an enlarged view showing the periphery of a right rear opening in FIG. 1 in an enlarged manner.
- (9) FIG. 9 is an illustrative diagram illustrating a state in which a male tab is inserted in a main body part.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view seen from a back side of the female terminal fitting of a second embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 11 is an illustrative diagram illustrating a first variation of the female terminal fitting in FIG. 10.
- (12) FIG. 12 is an illustrative diagram illustrating a second variation of the female terminal fitting in FIG. 10.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a right side view of the female terminal fitting of a third embodiment.
- (14) FIG. 14 is an enlarged view showing the periphery of a right rear opening in FIG. 13 in an enlarged manner.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION TO EXECUTE THE INVENTION

Description of Embodiments of Disclosure

- (15) Initially, embodiments of the present disclosure will be enumerated and described.
- (16) A female terminal fitting of the present disclosure includes:
 - (17) (1) a tubular main body part, and an elastic contact piece extending, inside the main body part, from a support point part to a free end part and contacting a partner-side male tab inserted in the main body part, the free end part side of the elastic contact piece displacing in a plate thickness direction of the elastic contact piece, and the main body part having a regulating part that comes in contact with the elastic contact piece and regulates a displacement range of the free end part side to less than or equal to a plate thickness of the elastic contact piece.
 - (18) By regulating the displacement range of the free end part side of the elastic contact piece to less than or equal to the plate thickness with the regulating part, the displacement amount of the support point part side of the elastic contact piece can be suppressed, as compared with the case where the displacement range is larger than the plate thickness. Thus, stress that occurs on the support point part side when an external force is applied to the elastic contact piece (e.g., when vibration occurs during transportation) can be reduced, and damage to the support point part side is more easily avoided.
 - (19) (2) Preferably, the elastic contact piece has a projecting part projecting from the free end part side in a width direction, the main body part has a side plate, the side plate is provided with an opening, the projecting part is located within the opening, and an edge part of the opening is constituted as the regulating part.
 - (20) According to this configuration, the displacement range is regulated to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece, due to the projecting part coming in contact with the regulating part constituted as an edge part of the opening. In this way, a configuration that regulates displacement of the elastic contact piece can be easily realized by providing an opening in the side plate of the main body part.
 - (21) (3) Preferably, the main body part has a bottom plate and a side plate standing erect from the bottom plate, the regulating part has a first regulating part provided on an erect side of the side

plate and a second regulating part provided at a position on an opposite side to the first regulating part across the free end part, and a distance between the first regulating part and the free end part is larger than a distance between the second regulating part and the free end part.

(22) According to this configuration, the free end part can be prevented from interfering with the first regulating part, when the side plate is erected from the bottom plate.

(23) (4) Preferably, the elastic contact piece has a contact point part that contacts the male tab, and a distance from the support point part to the contact point part is smaller than a distance from the contact point part to the free end part.

(24) According to this configuration, the contact point part can be brought closer to the support point part side, and the displacement amount of the support point part side of the elastic contact piece can be reduced, as compared with a configuration in which the contact point part is brought closer to the free end part side. Thus, stress that occurs on the support point part side when an external force is applied to the elastic contact piece can be further reduced.

Detailed Description of Embodiments of Disclosure

First Embodiment

(25) A first embodiment embodying a female terminal fitting of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **1** to **9**. In the first embodiment, with regard to the front and rear directions, leftward in FIGS. **1**, **4** to **7** and **9** is frontward and rightward is rearward. With regard to the up and down directions, upward and downward as they appear in FIGS. **1** to **3**, **6**, **8** and **9**. With regard to the left and right directions, leftward and rightward are as they appear in FIG. **2**.

(26) A female terminal fitting **10** of the first embodiment shown in FIG. **1** is integrally formed by a process such as bending a conductive metal plate, and is connectable to a male terminal fitting **110** on the partner side. The female terminal fitting **10** includes a main body part **20**, an elastic contact piece **40** (see FIG. **6**, etc.) and a wire connecting part **50**. The wire connecting part **50** has an open barrel shape, and a terminal part of an electrical wire is conductively connected by crimping.

(27) As shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the main body part **20** has a rectangular tube shape that is hollow throughout in the front-rear direction. A male tab **120** (see FIG. **9**) of the male terminal fitting **110** is inserted into the main body part **20**. The main body part **20** includes a bottom plate **21**, a left side plate **22** (see FIG. **3**), a right side plate **23** and a top plate **24**. The bottom plate **21** is a plate that is elongated in the front-rear direction. As shown in FIG. **5**, the bottom plate **21** is provided with a lance hole **21A**. The lance hole **21A** is open in a rectangular shape across the entirety of the bottom plate **21** in the left-right direction. As shown in FIG. **6**, the bottom plate **21** is provided with a protruding part **21B** on the frontward side of the lance hole **21A**. The protruding part **21B** is formed by being hammered out from the downward side, for example. The left side plate **22** and the right side plate **23** respectively stand erect from the left and right edges of the bottom plate **21**.

(28) The top plate **24** extends from the erect upper end of the right side plate **23** to the left side plate **22** side in parallel with the bottom plate **21**. Part of the left edge of the top plate **24** contacts the upper end of the left side plate **22** from the upper side. As shown in FIG. **6**, portions of the left edge of the top plate **24** that do not contact the upper end of the left side plate **22** are provided with a front side engaging plate **24A** and a rear side engaging plate **24B** that extend downward along the inner surface of the left side plate **22** (so as to overlap therewith).

(29) The rear side engaging plate **24B** is rectangular as a whole. The lower end of the rear side engaging plate **24B** is arranged at a low position (position close to bottom plate **21**) in the main body part **20**. A middle part of the lower end of the rear side engaging plate **24B** in the front-rear direction is provided with a cutout part **24C** that is recessed upward.

(30) As shown in FIG. **6**, a tab receiving part **24D** is formed in the top plate **24** by being downwardly hammered out. A tab entry space **24E** for the male tab **120** inserted into the main body part **20** from the front to enter is formed between the lower surface of the tab receiving part **24D** and the upper surface of the elastic contact piece **40** described later.

(31) As shown in FIG. **1**, the right side plate **23** is respectively provided with a right front opening

25 and a right rear opening 26 at front and rear positions. The right front opening 25 is provided at a position corresponding to the lower end of the front side engaging plate 24A (position overlapping therewith in left-right direction). The right front opening 25 has a rectangular shape. The right rear opening 26 is provided at a position corresponding to the cutout part 24C of the rear side engaging plate 24B (position overlapping therewith in left-right direction). The right rear opening 26 has a rectangular shape corresponding to the cutout part 24C of the rear side engaging plate 24B.

(32) As shown in FIG. 8, the main body part 20 is provided with a first regulating part 31 and a second regulating part 32. The first regulating part 31 and the second regulating part 32 come in contact with the elastic contact piece 40, and regulate a displacement range of a free end part 42 side of the elastic contact piece 40. The first regulating part 31 is provided in the right rear opening 26. The first regulating part 31 is provided on an erect side (upward side) of the right rear opening 26 in the right side plate 23. The first regulating part 31 is constituted by an edge part on the upward side of the right rear opening 26.

(33) As shown in FIG. 8, the second regulating part 32 is provided at a position on an opposite side (downward side) to the first regulating part 31 across the free end part 42 of the elastic contact piece 40. As shown in FIG. 6, the second regulating part 32 is provided on the bottom plate 21. The second regulating part 32 is provided at a position rearward of the lance hole 21A in the bottom plate 21. The second regulating part 32 supports the elastic contact piece 40 from below. The second regulating part 32 is formed to protrude by being hammered out from the downward side, for example. The second regulating part 32 comes in contact with the free end part 42 of the elastic contact piece 40 that is elastically deflected due to interference with the male tab 120, and supports the elastic contact piece 40.

(34) As shown in FIG. 6, the elastic contact piece 40 is housed within the main body part 20. The elastic contact piece 40 contacts the male tab 120 (see FIG. 9) of the male terminal fitting 110 inserted in the main body part 20. As shown in FIG. 6, the elastic contact piece 40 doubles back from the front end of the bottom plate 21 and extends rearward in a cantilever manner. The elastic contact piece 40 has a shape elongated in the front-rear direction, extending from a support point part (bent part) 41 to the free end part 42. The support point part 41 has a semicircular arc shape continuous with the front end of the bottom plate 21. The elastic contact piece 40 has an extension part 44. The extension part 44 extends rearward from the support point part 41. The extension part 44 is provided with a front inclining part 44A and a rear inclining part 44B. The front inclining part 44A extends rearward diagonally upward from the upper end of the support point part 41. The rear inclining part 44B extends rearward diagonally downward from the rear end of the front inclining part 44A.

(35) In a free state (natural state) in which the elastic contact piece 40 is not elastically deflected, the free end part 42 is in a non-contact position upward of the bottom plate 21. Thus, the elastic contact piece 40 is in a state of being supported in a cantilever manner at the front end thereof by the bottom plate 21. The elastic contact piece 40 can be elastically deformed in the up-down direction while elastically deflecting mainly at the support point part 41, with the support point part 41 as the support point. The free end part 42 side of the elastic contact piece 40 displaces in the plate thickness direction of the elastic contact piece 40. The elastic contact piece 40, when elastically deflected downward, will be supported at both the front and rear ends, due to the free end part 42 coming in contact with the second regulating part 32 of the bottom plate 21.

(36) As shown in FIG. 6, the rear end (highest portion) of the front inclining part 44A is provided with a contact point part 45 in a form upwardly hammered out into a dome shape. The contact point part 45 contacts the male tab 120 (see FIG. 9). The distance from the support point part 41 to the contact point part 45 is smaller than the distance from the contact point part 45 to the free end part 42.

(37) As shown in FIG. 7, a pair of front side projecting parts 46 and a pair of rear side projecting

parts **47** are provided front and rear on left and right edge parts of the elastic contact piece **40**. The front side projecting parts **46** and the rear side projecting parts **47** are in a form projecting in a flush manner outwardly in the width direction. The front side projecting parts **46** are arranged in the vicinity of the contact point part **45**, that is, in a position slightly frontward of the contact point part **45**. The front side projecting parts **46** are positioned so as to correspond to the lower edge part of the front side engaging plate **24A** and to the right front opening **25** in the front-rear direction. In the free state (natural state) in which the elastic contact piece **40** is not elastically deflected, the upper surface of the front side projecting part **46** on the left side is in a non-contact position slightly downward of the lower edge part of the front side engaging plate **24A**. The upper surface of the front side projecting part **46** on the right side is in a non-contact position slightly downward of the upper edge part of the right front opening **25**.

(38) As shown in FIG. 7, the rear side projecting parts **47** project in the width direction (left-right direction) from the free end part **42** side. The rear side projecting parts **47** constitute part of the free end part **42**. The rear side projecting parts **47** are positioned so as to correspond to the cutout part **24C** of the rear side engaging plate **24B** and to the right rear opening **26** in the front-rear direction. The rear side projecting part **47** on the right side is located within the right rear opening **26**. In the free state (natural state) in which the elastic contact piece **40** is not elastically deflected, the upper surface of the rear side projecting part **47** on the left side is in a non-contact position slightly downward of the cutout part **24C** of the rear contact plate **24B**. The upper surface of the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side is in a non-contact position slightly downward of the first regulating part **31**. At this time, the distance between the upper surface of the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side and the first regulating part **31** is smaller than the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece **40**. The lower surface of the free end part **42** including the rear side projecting part **47** on the left side and the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side contacts the second regulating part **32**. Note that the lower surface of the free end part **42** may be in close proximity to the second regulating part **32** rather than in contact therewith.

(39) The first regulating part **31** and the second regulating part **32** come in contact with the elastic contact piece **40**, and regulate the displacement range of the free end part **42** side of the elastic contact piece **40** to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece **40**. That is, the free end part **42** of the elastic contact piece **40** displaces by a distance less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece **40** when changing between the state of coming in contact with the first regulating part **31** and the state of coming in contact with the second regulating part **32** (when displacing in up-down direction).

(40) As shown in FIG. 8, the length of the gap between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** (rear side projecting parts **47**) in the up-down direction is **L1** at a most frontward portion (portion along front edge of rear side projecting parts **47**), is **L2** at a center portion (center portion of rear side projecting parts **47** in front-rear direction), and is **L3** at a most rearward portion (portion along rear edge of rear side projecting parts **47**). The lengths (**L1**, **L2**, **L3**) of the gap between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** (rear side projecting parts **47**) are smaller than a plate thickness **L4** of the elastic contact piece **40**.

(41) In the case of the configuration in which the lower surface of the free end part **42** is in close proximity to the second regulating part **32** when the elastic contact piece **40** is in the free state (natural state), the distance between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** is larger than the distance between the second regulating part **32** and the free end part **42**.

(42) The gap between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** when the elastic contact piece **40** is in the free state (natural state) gradually increases proceeding rearward. That is, the lengths (**L1**, **L2**, **L3**) of the gap between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** increase in the order **L1**, **L2**, **L3**.

(43) When connecting the male terminal fitting **110** to the female terminal fitting **10**, the male tab **120** is inserted into the tab entry space **24E** of the main body part **20** from the frontward side. The

male tab **120** inserted in the tab entry space **24E** is elastically sandwiched between the tab receiving part **24D** and the contact point part **45** while elastically deflecting the elastic contact piece **40**. The male tab **120** and the main body part **20** are conductively connected due to the elastic restoring force of the elastic contact piece **40**.

(44) As described above, the female terminal fitting **10** of the present disclosure is able to suppress the displacement amount of the support point part **41** side of the elastic contact piece **40**, as compared with the case where the displacement range is larger than the plate thickness, by regulating the displacement range of the free end part **42** side of the elastic contact piece **40** to less than or equal to the plate thickness with the first regulating part **31** and the second regulating part **32**. Thus, stress that occurs on the support point part **41** side when an external force is applied to the elastic contact piece **40** (e.g., when vibration occurs during transportation) can be reduced, and damage to the support point part **41** side is more easily avoided.

(45) In the female terminal fitting **10** of the present disclosure, the displacement range is regulated to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece **40**, due to the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side coming in contact with the first regulating part **31** constituted as an edge part of the right rear opening **26**. In this way, a configuration that regulates the displacement of the elastic contact piece **40** can be easily realized by providing an opening in the right side plate **23** of the main body part **20**.

(46) In the female terminal fitting **10** of the present disclosure, the distance between the first regulating part **31** and the free end part **42** is larger than the distance between the second regulating part **32** and the free end part **42**. With this configuration, the free end part **42** can be prevented from interfering with the first regulating part **31**, when the right side plate **23** is erected from the bottom plate **21**.

(47) In the female terminal fitting **10** of the present disclosure, the distance from the support point part **41** to the contact point part **45** of the elastic contact piece **40** is smaller than the distance from the contact point part **45** to the free end part **42**. With this configuration, the contact point part **45** can be brought closer to the support point part **41** side, and the displacement amount of the support point part **41** side of the elastic contact piece **40** can be reduced, as compared with a configuration in which the contact point part **45** is brought closer to the free end part **42** side. Thus, stress that occurs on the support point part **41** side when an external force is applied to the elastic contact piece **40** can be further reduced.

Second Embodiment

(48) FIG. **10** is a diagram illustrating a female terminal fitting **210** of a second embodiment. In the second embodiment, the configuration of the first regulating part differs from the first embodiment. The remaining configuration is the same as the first embodiment, and detailed description thereof will be omitted.

(49) As shown in FIG. **10**, in the female terminal fitting **210**, an upper edge part of the right rear opening **26** is provided with a first regulating part **231**. The first regulating part **231** is bent to the inner side of the main body part **20** from the upper edge part of the right rear opening **26**. The first regulating part **231** is bent so as to incline relative to the plate surface of the right side plate **23**. In the free state (natural state) in which the elastic contact piece **40** is not elastically deflected, the upper surface of the free end part **42** is in a non-contact position slightly downward of the first regulating part **231**. At this time, the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side and a portion of the free end part **42** inward of the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side in the left-right direction (portion adjacent to the rear side projecting part **47** on the right side) oppose the first regulating part **231** in the up-down direction.

(50) As shown in FIG. **11**, the left side portion of the distal end of the first regulating part **231** may be faceted and beveled. As shown in FIG. **12**, a first regulating part **331** may be formed by inwardly hammering out part of the right side plate **23**.

Third Embodiment

(51) FIGS. 13 and 14 are diagrams illustrating a female terminal fitting 410 of a third embodiment. In the third embodiment, the configurations of the free end part 42 of the elastic contact piece 40 and a second regulating part 432 differ from the first embodiment. The remaining configuration is the same as the first embodiment, and detailed description thereof will be omitted.

(52) As shown in FIGS. 13 and 14, the second regulating part 432 is configured by a portion of the bottom plate 21 corresponding to the right rear opening 26 (portion overlapping with right rear opening 26 in left-right direction). In the elastic contact piece 40, a free end part 442 that includes a pair of rear side projecting parts 447 curves downward in a convex manner.

(53) The first regulating part 31 and the second regulating part 432 come in contact with the elastic contact piece 40, and regulate the displacement range of the free end part 442 side of the elastic contact piece 40 to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece 40. That is, the free end part 442 of the elastic contact piece 40 displaces by a distance less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece 40 when changing between the state of coming in contact with the first regulating part 31 and the state of coming in contact with the second regulating part 432 (when displacing in up-down direction).

(54) As shown in FIG. 14, the length of the gap between the first regulating part 31 and the free end part 442 (rear side projecting parts 447) in the up-down direction is L41 at a most frontward portion 440 (portion along front edge of rear side projecting parts 447), is L42 at a center portion (center portion of rear side projecting parts 447 in front-rear direction), and is L43 at a most rearward portion (portion along rear edge part of the rear side projecting parts 447). The lengths (L41, L42, L43) of the gap between the first regulating part 31 and the free end part 442 (rear side projecting parts 447) are smaller than the plate thickness L4 of the elastic contact piece 40.

Other Embodiments

(55) The present invention is not limited to the first to third embodiments described above with reference to the drawings, and is defined by the claims. All changes that come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are intended to be embraced in the invention, and embodiments such as the following are also intended to be embraced therein.

(56) In the first embodiment, the first regulating part 31 and the second regulating part 32 are configured to regulate the displacement range of the free end part 42 side of the elastic contact piece 40 to less than or equal to the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece 40. However, the first regulating part 31 and the second regulating part 32 may be configured to regulate the displacement range of the free end part 42 side of the elastic contact piece 40 to less than or equal to half of the plate thickness of the elastic contact piece 40.

LIST OF REFERENCE NUMERALS

(57) 10, 210, 410 Female terminal fitting 20 Main body part 21 Bottom plate 21A Lance hole 21B Protruding part 22 Left side plate 23 Right side plate (side plate) 24 Top plate 24A Front side engaging plate 24B Rear side engaging plate 24C Cutout part 24D Tab receiving part 24E Tab entry space 25 Right front opening 26 Right rear opening (opening) 31, 231, 331 First regulating part (regulating part) 32, 432 Second regulating part (regulating part) 40 Elastic contact piece 41 Support point part (bent part) 42, 442 Free end part 44 Extension part 44A Front inclining part 44B Rear inclining part 45 Contact point part 46 Front side projecting part (projecting part) 47, 447 Rear side projecting part (projecting part) 50 Wire connecting part 110 Male terminal fitting 120 Male tab

Claims

1. A female terminal fitting comprising: a main body part having a tubular shape; and an elastic contact piece extending, inside the main body part, from a support point part to a free end part and contacting part, the elastic contact piece configured to contact a partner-side male tab inserted in the main body part, wherein a free end part side of the elastic contact piece displaces in a plate

thickness direction of the elastic contact piece, the main body part includes a regulating part that comes in contact with the elastic contact piece and regulates a displacement range of the free end part side to less than or equal to a plate thickness of the elastic contact piece; a bottom plate; and a side plate standing erect from the bottom plate and having an opening for receiving a projecting part of the elastic contact piece, the projecting part projecting from the free end part side in a width direction, the regulating part includes a first regulating part provided on an erect side of the side plate and a second regulating part formed to protrude from the bottom plate at a position opposite to an edge part of the opening of the side plate across the projecting part from the edge part of the opening.

2. The female terminal fitting according to claim 1, wherein the projecting part is located within the opening, and the edge part of the opening is constituted as the first regulating part.

3. The female terminal fitting according to claim 1, wherein a distance between the first regulating part and the free end part is larger than a distance between the second regulating part and the free end part.

4. The female terminal fitting according to claim 1, wherein the elastic contact piece has a contact point part that contacts the partner-side male tab, and a distance from the support point part to the contact point part is smaller than a distance from the contact point part to the free end part.

5. The female terminal fitting according to claim 1, wherein the first regulating part is formed by bending an upper edge part of the opening toward an inner side of the main body part to form a bend in the side plate, and a distal end of the first regulating part opposes the projecting part in an up-down direction.

6. The female terminal fitting according to claim 5, wherein an inner side portion of the distal end of the first regulating part is faceted and beveled.

7. The female terminal fitting according to claim 1, wherein the first regulating part is formed by inwardly hammering out part of the side plate.
